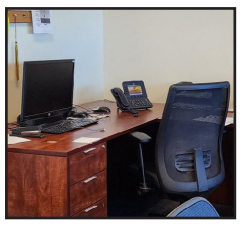
ANDOVER VIEW

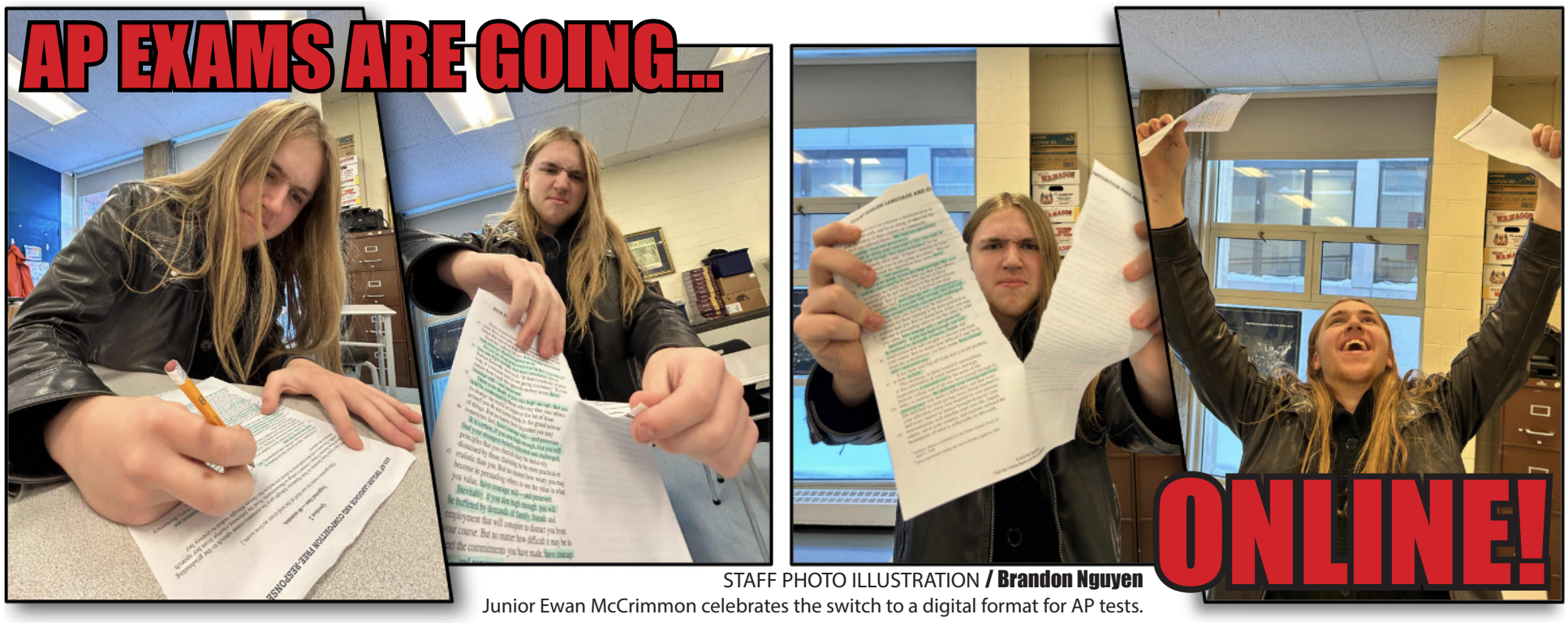
New Year's Resolutions / 2

New Principal Search / 3

New Building Renovations / 4



Volume 5, Issue 2 | www.andoverview.net | JANUARY 25, 2024



STAFF PHOTO ILLUSTRATION / **Brandon Nguyen**
Junior Ewan McCrimmon celebrates the switch to a digital format for AP tests.

Five AP Exams to Go Online This Spring

By Brandon Nguyen and Jill Slotnick
LAYOUT EDITOR AND CORRESPONENTS EDITOR

The AP exams for AP European History, AP Computer Science, AP English Language Composition, AP English Literature, and AP United States History classes are to go online this spring.

According to the College Board, all Advanced Placement Tests available in the digital format will be completely online by 2025. The option for these digital tests became available during the 2022-2023 school year. AP Coordinator and Head of Guidance Aixa de Kelley said the AHS administration had been discussing this change for the last few years but had ultimately decided they should wait until it was proven the tests could be administered online successfully. The choice to go digital this year was approved by de Kelley.

AHS Administration decided to go through with the switch after feedback they received nationally and locally. "From our experience last fall with the digital PSATs, offering the exam in the digital format streamlined the process. We received only positive feedback from students at AHS who took the digital PSAT exams," said Dr. Magda Parvey, the Andover Public Schools superintendent. The administration also took into account feedback collected by the College Board, which stated that "students nationwide who participated in the digital exams [preferred the digital] format, especially when it comes to the long essays. Typing the responses was much easier and more familiar for them than handwriting responses."

In regards to the actual content of the tests, the digital exam itself has the same number of sections, the same amount of questions, and has a parallel format for writing as well, said de Kelley. Students will also be using school-provided laptops which takes away the stress of having to remember a computer and charger, and downloading a lockdown browser in addition to an already nerve-racking exam.

With the decision coming out only a week before Thanksgiving break, many teachers were caught off guard. For three months, teachers had been preparing their classes for a paper exam. Michelle Chachus, an AP US History (APUSH) teacher for over ten years, expressed her discontent with the switch. "In my class we focus on annotating documents and highlighting key ideas, and I think that becomes a lot more challenging [with] a digital test. I know there are digital highlighting tools, but I feel I need to really process what's in the document."

Some teachers also had concerns regarding College Board's previous digital AP Exams. Jennifer Percival, an AP English Language Composition (AP Lang) teacher, brought up the AP digital exam during the pandemic. "The platform that College Board is going to use should be more user-friendly than it was in the past to accommodate COVID. During the test, people had trouble with multiple choice questions and going back to questions they've already answered." Percival also questioned the equitability of the digital exam. "I think it would be better if [the exam] was on paper," she explained. "This switch affects not only our community of learners but also many other communities where digital learning isn't as prevalent or easily accessible."

The school seems divided on the issue of online testing, de Kelley admitted. "Some teachers were a little nervous; some teachers were happy about it," she said. "They realize that computers are what kids are used to writing on, instead of with paper and pencil."

For students, the announcement seems to have also caused disagreement. Ewan McCrimmon, a junior taking APUSH, welcomed the move. "It's a lot less paper, and it's accommodating to the new way the world works online. Not many people write stuff down on paper anymore," he said. But, McCrimmon also had some concerns about the school's technological readiness: "Last year's MCAS was a shame… [the school's wifi] was struggling to keep up with everyone logging in all at once."

Magdalena Phelps, a junior taking AP Lang and APUSH, was more opposed to the change: "I'm just more of a visual person, so being able to interact with the text helps a lot." Worried about the late announcement and lack of resources, she added, "In APUSH and AP Lang, [the work] is very much on paper, so [it's hard to know] how they're going to transition." Both Phelps and McCrimmon agreed that students should be able to choose whether or not to have their exams be paper or digital.

Underage Gambling All the Rage at AHS

Carissa Dessin and Eva Liss
SPORTS EDITOR AND COPY EDITOR

Gambling has proven to be one of the most morally questionable and controversial activities participated in to this day. One facet of gambling that has become quite popular in the past few years, due to its legalization in 2018, is online sports betting. With endless advertising from apps like DraftKings and Fanduel, it is hard to ignore. This is obvious even within AHS, where online gambling seems to have found a home—even though most students are underage.

GAMBLING / **page 3**

STAFF PHOTO / **Saarvi Deshwal**
AHS student uses sports betting app DraftKings in school. An increased interest in gambling encouraged more students to begin.

STAFF PHOTO / **Julia Rodenberger**
Abigail Wertz, from Lawrence General Hospital, teaches students how to properly care for open wounds.

AHS Students Learn How To 'Stop the Bleed'

Julia Rodenberger || STAFF WRITER

AHS students received certificates in stopping traumatic bleeding after training offered by emergency room professionals during H4 on December 5.

Medical Opportunities Club, led by juniors Lakshi Jayaprakash and Shriyaa Anandakumar, partnered with the Lawrence General Hospital to host Stop the Bleed: a nationwide campaign sponsored by the American College of Surgeons to address death by blood loss. Abigail Wertz, the program general of the trauma program at Lawrence General Hospital, led the free instruction alongside two emergency room nurses.

Attendees were provided the opportunity to step away if sensitive to gore; however, no real images of blood were shown. Trainers utilized rubber tubes with faux flesh wounds to demonstrate how to administer tourniquets and gauze onto severe injuries including lacerations, impalements, and amputation.

Jayaprakash and Anandakumar began volunteering in the Emergency Center at Lawrence General Hospital this past summer, through which they were introduced to Stop the Bleed. "When I took the class at Lawrence General, there were people of various age groups," Anandakumar elaborated. "It's not just for students. Anybody can take it; it's an important skill."

The H-Block was open to all, drawing students and staff with varying interests beyond traditional medicine. More than 20 participants attended. Attendance numbers surpassed 20 participants.

Junior Dylan Moses participated in Stop the Bleed with aspirations to work for the Coast Guard in Search and Rescue. "First aid plays a big role in those fields," Mose stated.

Moses expanded on the importance of first aid experience for high school communities.

"Unfortunately there's been a number of school shootings, and individuals with gunshot wounds could be saved

STOP THE BLEED / **page 3**

EDITORIAL

Students Sacrifice Passion in the Pursuit of Admission

In today's higher education, a record number of students are applying to college, decreasing acceptance rates every year. This coincides with the increasing number of colleges each student applies to. Soaring tuition costs and cut-throat competition have coerced students into prioritizing the destination over the journey, directing a shift away from pursuing extracurricular activities for true interest, passion, or enjoyment.

The statistics are stark. According to a report by the Common Application, "The number of college applicants jumped 20% since the 2019-2020 school year, pushing acceptance rates to all-time lows." For the class of 2027, Harvard University admitted only 3.4% of its 56,000 applicants, echoing the pattern evident in other Ivy League schools, where acceptance rates are below 5%. Yet, the magnitude of this challenge extends beyond the Ivy League, as seen in several elite institutions across the country.

This drop in acceptance rates has intensified the pressure on students to stand out in such an extreme pool of applicants. Students find themselves pursuing resume-building activities that appeal to admission officers, sometimes at the expense of exploring their authentic interests.

While this strategic move to enhance their application to stand out is understandable, extracurricular activities not motivated by intrinsic interest result in missed opportunities to foster personal growth, skill development, and a sense of fulfillment. Emphasizing college admission fosters a competitive atmosphere that hampers the potential for collaborative and meaningful experiences among students who participate in activities for the sheer joy of exploration and learning.

The trend in pursuing extracurricular activities primarily for college admission highlights the challenges of the current landscape of higher education. While strategic planning has its benefits, a more balanced and authentic approach to extracurriculars is essential. Encouraging students to pursue activities aligned with their genuine interests and passions can enhance their college application by showcasing internal motivation and true enjoyment for the activity. It also contributes to a more fulfilling and enriching personal academic journey.

The admissions process is becoming increasingly complex and unreasonable, and students across the nation shouldn't have to sacrifice their passions for a shot at higher education.

ANDOVER VIEW

Andover High School
80 Shawsheen Road
Andover, Massachusetts 01810
andoverview.net

STAFF

Co-Editors in Chief
Anusha Sambangi
Angela Mac

Copy Editors
Julie Mahoney
Eva Liss

Online Editor
Melody Tang

Layout Editors
Harry Guo
Brandon Nguyen

Sports Editor
Carissa Dessin

Correspondents Editor
Jill Slotnick

Faculty Advisor
Mr. Aubrey

ANDOVERVIEW is a publication written, edited and designed by the Newspaper Production class to serve as an open forum for students to discuss issues relevant to the Andover High School community. Letters to the editor and guest commentaries are encouraged; please email submissions to the following address:

andoverview@andoverma.us.

If you would like to write for us or join the newspaper staff, please visit the Write for Us page for more information.

Include contact information for verification purposes. The staff of ANDOVERVIEW reviews letters to the editor and guest commentaries and reserves the right to refuse material for reasons pertaining to length, clarity, libel, obscenity, copyright infringement, or material disruption to the educational process of Andover High School.

Staff
Molly Borenstein
Abby Chachus
Saarvi Deshwal
Anushka Dole
Lojyn Elkotory
Anya Gorovits
Ella Hu
Samiha Jaffar Ali
Jiya Jotwani
Sanjith Kalpat
Tommy Kruecker-Green
Xander MacKay-Kao
Vismay Ravikumar
Julia Rodenberger
Samantha Sun
Ariana Teasdale
Minati Thota
Maddox To
Grace Wang
Isabella Yan

ILLUSTRATION / **Melody Tang**

Hopes and Dreams Brought By 2024

Melody Tang and Grace Wang
ONLINE EDITOR AND STAFF WRITER

With the New Year just recently passing, dreams and aspirations revolve through AHS. Have you thought about New Year's resolutions? Have you ever had a New Year's resolution, or was it just something that old people did? Although many of our fellow classmates didn't have official resolutions when interviewed, they certainly had goals.

Sophomore Smeet Patel said "[his] goal is to be an NBA player… get better at basketball, make the varsity team, and keep [getting] good grades." Ever since Patel was eight years old, he's played basketball. He acknowledged that it would be a long journey. But he had more to say. "[Despite it being a difficult battle,] I know I got this. I just need to put in the work," reaffirmed Patel.

Senior Hridai Dharan had similar goals regarding physical fitness. "My goal for [this] year is to go to the gym," said Dharan. "I want to start getting more in shape and get a routine going." Dharan mentioned that going with friends who have similar gym goals would help motivate him and keep him on track. "[My friends] can keep me accountable and [we can] set up a schedule and just go from there," Dharan planned.

Senior Matthew Vakilynejad also held similar goals, hoping to excel in his sports endeavors. "I want to make the MVCS (Merrimack Valley Conference Championship) for shot put," said Vakilynejad. Last season, he almost qualified, but fouled out of the circle, disqualifying him. This year, Vakilynejad is determined to fulfill what he couldn't in the past and has been practicing diligently.

Other students had academically oriented goals, whether it be reaching new academic heights or maintaining satisfactory grades. "I would like to get all As for sure," said sophomore Milena Tiernan, as a benchmark goal. Sophomore Sofia Fakhiri had similar ideas to improve from negative past experiences, this time attempting to maintain what was already had. "I would like to stay organized because, during the end of the year, I kind of lose that," Fakhiri remarked.

In addition, Tiernan expressed a desire to achieve more personal goals. A goal of hers was to "make sure [she has] some time to do some hobbies that [she hasn't] really been able to do," such as baking brownies, cinnamon rolls, or apple pie. Tiernan added that a big factor to having time for hobbies is time management, which connects to her academic goal. "I haven't really had time in a while," stated Tiernan.

But will everyone be able to pursue these goals? Often, people forget about their goals as time passes. Many students forget to tick the box after they've completed the goal. "Normally, I'm locked in about the goals in the first couple of months, and then after I kind of forget it's a New Year's resolution," chimed Dharan. "[It just becomes] daily life." Other students simply don't follow through with their goals, eventually forgetting their resolution as time passes. "I just don't remember [my goals]," confessed Vakilynejad. "They usually don't work out. [They last] maybe a month." Let's hope our future shotput MVC champion achieves this year's goal.

However, NBA contender Patel swoops in with inspiration. He asserts, "Don't listen to anybody who tells you [that] you can't do it [or] it's too hard. It's all on you. You just need to put your mind to it. Work hard. Don't give up. God is watching. God is giving you energy. It's all on you to work hard to put your work in and succeed."

Have an opinion you want to share? Email us at andoverview@andoverma.us!

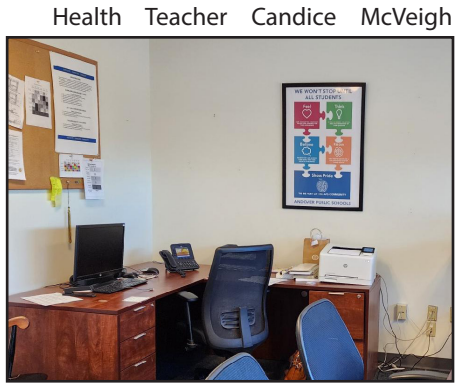
Search Begins for a Permanent Principal

Abby Chachus || STAFF WRITER

After the hiring of interim principal Elizabeth Taylor, the search for a long-term principal will begin shortly.

Staff members and students of AHS expressed their hopes for certain qualities of the new principal.

Health Teacher Candice McVeigh stated, "I would like to see the new principal be a former educator, a great communicator, and someone who connects with students as well as adults."



STAFF PHOTO / **Abby Chachus**
The principal's office is ready to be permantly claimed.

McVeigh has had nine or more different principals that she has worked for in her AHS career. Although this is a lot, she explained that it has brought her to realize the good qualities that she has seen in the past that she would like to continue to see. She said, "The last few principals have been thoughtful, understanding, and real school people, so we are in the position to attract another great principal."

Sophomore Milena Tiernan stated that she is sure that multiple good principal candidates will apply to AHS because of the high level of education that students receive.

Want to read the rest of the story?
Check out our website at
andoverview.net!

Instructors Teach Life-Saving First Aid

STOP THE BLEED / **from page 1**

STAFF PHOTO / **Julia Rodenberger**
Students listen closely as instructors teach them how to stop traumatic bleeding.

through treatment that is taught here," Moses added. "I just want to be well vested in first aid in case I encounter problems in my life."

Wertz repeatedly emphasized that traumatic bleeding is the number one preventable cause of death in the United States. Following a period of instruction, attendees were able to work firsthand with the faux medical supplies under supervision from Wertz and the two nurses.

Medical Opportunities Club meets every Wednesday at 3:00 pm in room 220, with opportunities for members to engage in various research projects. "The first one—you'll see it on the H block—is a research campaign to analyze vaping in the student body," Jayaprakash explained. "We're working with the principal and the school administration to tackle the vaping problem."

Illegal Sports Betting Becomes Increasingly Popular With Students

GAMBLING / **from page 1**

Betting on sports isn't solely focused on the outcome or the score of a game, but it can also involve betting on the performance of a certain player (for example, how many points they score or how many yards they run.) As fun as this may sound, the state legislature determines whether or not sports gambling is allowed in the state. Massachusetts is one of the 38 states and the District of Columbia that allows it for those 21 and older. This hasn't seemed to stop many AHS students.

A senior, one of several students who agreed to speak to ANDOVERVIEW provided their names were not shared, said that they "downloaded an app called Fliff" after learning about the hobby through some friends and "seniors last year [who bet]." Likewise, an anonymous junior said they got started by "seeing other people do it." Students also talked about the social aspect rather than adrenaline or profit as what attracts the people to betting.

"Doing it with fake money is nice," the junior said. Many of the betting apps such as Fliff and DraftKings use a certain amount of money that comes when bettors set up an account. These apps often don't allow money to be transferred without verifying that the user is 18 or older, which limits underage bettors in their options even if it isn't foolproof. This policy is also beneficial for underage bettors, who despite doing something illegal want to be responsible with their money. Another senior said they've "never deposited any money in [their] account since [they] started," and that "if [they] ever got to that point [they] think [they'd] stop." Although betting seemed to be a source of pride among students, there was also a strong emphasis placed on only betting if it was profitable.

"If it ever gets to the point where it starts hurting me, I hope I'd stop," said a junior. Self-regulation seemed to be an important part of underage betting for students, who all talked about how they tried to be responsible and bet small amounts.

"The most I've ever put down on anything was $50, but usually I'll put down $10 or $20. The most I've ever won was probably $200," said one senior. The same senior also said they bet "once a day or once every other day," while an anonymous junior said that they only do it "three or four times a week."

> "[I bet] once a day or once every other day"

The AHS Student Handbook states that any person found participating in "gambling and games of chance" will be subject to "detention(s) and confiscation of cards, games, or electronic devices." Whilestudent bettors haven't specified where or when they do it, there is definitely a lot of talk floating through the halls. Michael Scarfo, an English teacher, said H-block is the time when he hears students talking about it the most.

Teachers and administrators have made it very clear that they do not advocate or condone any sort of sports gambling or betting among students. When students who bet gather in Scarfo's H Block, he warns them "to be wary and cautious of getting into [gambling] at an early age," as he sees gambling as a bad habit formed when young that can prove to be very dangerous in the future.

"It's not allowed here at the school just like smoking isn't allowed here," Interim Principal Betty Taylor said. She also stated that the dangers of starting a habit like that so young is a conversation that needs to happen more in schools and among families. Although Taylor spoke of widening awareness of students' participation in online gambling within the administration, she said that there was no solid plan to decrease the habit among the student body. "I did speak to Dr. Parvey," said Taylor, adding that families might expect an email regarding reports of underage betting in the student body.

Opinions on sports gambling have been split in history, split in the courts, and are clearly split in the halls of AHS, but one thing is clear— sports betting is a very real and prevalent pastime at AHS.

Foreign Exchange Program Returns to AHS

Saarvi Deshwal || STAFF WRITER

A group of students from South Korea is currently visiting AHS from January 19 to 30, and a group of students from Vietnam will visit from February 3 to 13.

The Global Pathways program at AHS works with the Academy at Harvard Square (TAHS) to make the exchange program possible. The organization collaborates with the non-profit Educational Divide Reform (EDR) to promote global education, with a focus on Asian students learning English. One of the major goals of Global Pathways is to foster cultural and academic diversity through enriching experiences.

"In Global Pathways, one of the components is to have an immersive experience, whether that's by travel or looking at more in-house opportunities like this," said Global Pathways advisor Rebecca D'Alise. "So we've been trying to encourage our students in Global Pathways to host these students so they can have an immersive experience that way."

Since early November, students have had the opportunity to register to host exchange students from South Korea and Vietnam, regardless of whether they are a part of Global Pathways or not. It's an opportunity for students from other countries to learn what it's like to be a student in the United States. It's also a chance for AHS students to learn about different cultures. "You just never know how things are different until you have to turn and explain something to them that is normal for everyone else around you," said librarian Mary Coombs, "and now you know that this is a special thing, and we didn't know it was special."

The program hopes for AHS students to be able to share their lifestyles with those coming from abroad because "that's what this program's all about; experiencing those cultural differences, finding similarities, finding differences, and celebrating those differences. I only see upsides," commented D'Alise.

Want to read the rest of the story?
Check out our website at
andoverview.net!

COURTESY PHOTO / **Lana Huynh**
Sophomore Lana Huynh prepares a guest bedroom for her foreign exchange student.

Andover Collection
Andover Warriors and Town Merchandise
Follow us on Instagram
@andovercollection
for our latest merchandise, sales and special holiday and event extended hours
Conveniently located downtown. Open Mon-Fri 11AM-5PM, Sat 10AM-5PM.
40 Main Street, Andover, MA 01810
Tel: 978-409-2245
www. AndoverCollection.com

COURTESY PHOTO / **John Berube**
The library as the foyer before renovations in 1996.

Prior AHS Renovations Found To Be Lacking for Current School Needs

Lojyn Elkotory and Minati Thota || STAFF WRITERS

The new school building plans were rejected during The Andover Town Meeting on November 20, 2023, and an interim plan involving modular classrooms will be imposed until the town explores further funding avenues. This isn't the first time an Andover High School Building Committee has had a renovation plan, nor is it the first to be abandoned– a glance at the building's history can tell us why.

The AHS Building Committee decided to dissolve the $451.5 Million plan after the setback; the proposed plan aimed at renovations and improvements to meet the evolving educational needs of the school. The breakdown of the budget included allocations for state-of-the-art classrooms, enhanced athletic facilities, and enhanced learning spaces.

When questioned about the necessity for a new building, Scott Darlington emphasized, "The part that we're not really up to state standards with for space is the academic areas, and specifically the special education areas."

In response to the rejection, the committee pivoted towards an interim solution, proposing a $50 million alternative. The committee secured $500,000 for a detailed study of this interim strategy. The plan involves the installation of a modular classroom outside the existing building. Darlington shed light on the approved $50 million plan, stating that the "portable classrooms would allow for more classes to be scheduled, [thus alleviating] some of the overcrowding." Yet, the temporary plan is facing some safety challenges. Having the classroom outside exposes the students to dangerous factors as well as weather fluctuations. Darlignton showcases his concerns " Safety, security, also just access for students that have mobility issues…those are all logistics that we'll have to deal with."The plan is expected to be in place for approximately 10 years until the town explores other options, [such as] seeking matching funding from the Massachusetts School Building Authority.

This isn't the first time thousands of dollars have been spent on these studies. School librarian John Berube said that he has been part of "countless such committees" to plan for a new building in his 24 years of working at AHS. The building was originally built in 1968 and wasn't built to house a student population as large as ours today. It was given its first and only renovation in 1996, three years before Berube began to work at AHS. This was a huge turnaround; the new foyer was built from what was originally a parking lot between the school building and the Dunn Gym building. (A plaque to indicate an old vice principal's parking spot by the entrance to the Dunn Gym was only painted over last summer.) The library was originally the foyer, with stairs coming in through the cafeteria. "So the two staircases are still buried under the library floor," said Berube. He also recollects a large auditorium-style lecture hall that was removed to create the engineering classrooms and more rooms on the second floor. Berube believes that these changes were necessary, but there is still room for improvement.

"It all comes down to money," he said. "They'll get a plan and they'll do a study but they don't pull the trigger." The building also has to be brought up to code, which means that certain safety regulations must be checked and repaired to begin renovation. "It's actually cheaper to build a new building than to [renovate]," Berube commented. He states that waiting until the state can shoulder most of the renovation costs would be the safest bet for AHS at this time. He believes that portable classrooms are a great idea for overcoming overcrowding. "It's a good stopgap measure," as he said, and would help us function until some of the costs for the new building have been handled.

In the future, Berube hopes to see a school building that would provide the students with a safe and all-round fruitful educational experience. He reminisces about the woodworking shops and other vocational activities that AHS once offered. He believes that the new school building, whenever it comes, should open up access to add more courses and learning opportunities for the growth of our student body.

Andover Discusses Renovations and Sustainability Amidst Recent Town Vote

Molly Borenstein || STAFF WRITER

In the wake of a pivotal town meeting on November 20, Andover High School finds itself at a crossroads, steering away from a proposed $1.3 million plan for a new facility and opting instead for a $500,000 investment in interim renovations.

With so many options, it's hard to keep track of all the future plans, whether that be in terms of renovations to the current building, portable classrooms, or even a brand new shiny school.

When beginning these conversations, it is important to recognize the substantial impact of COVID-19. It created much-needed auditing and ventilation system tracking, said Vice Principal Scott Darlington. He also elaborated that "storage spaces were converted into learning spaces, and additional ventilation was introduced." During the years of the pandemic, not only were new systems implemented quickly and therefore somewhat quickly, staff, students, and the population as a whole began to learn more about air quality and ventilation.

Currently, the HVAC (heating/ventilation/air conditioning) system in AHS, now at the end of its life, draws fresh air from outside but grapples with heating and cooling – a chief concern of the community, as stated by Darlington. Currently, AHS also has carbon dioxide monitors and temperature sensors in each room, but there isn't a clear resolution or way to fix excess C02 or unhealthy overcrowding if issues are detected. Solutions to excess C02, along with an update in the current HVAC system, would be updated in any of the three renovation plans. The community as a whole is hoping that in any new renovation, portable classroom, or completely new school, a more cohesive HVAC system with improved control, windows in every room for natural light, and a commitment to addressing sustainability concerns will be present in each one.

Yet, not every plan, from renovations to a whole new school, has the same outcome. Portable, outdoor classrooms have been brought to the forefront of the community's mind after the recent town meeting, and were met with both backlash and support from practical and environmental views.

From the student perspective, Paige Luis, a senior enrolled in the Environmental Sustainability Internship Course, noted, "I think that the portable classrooms are a great option for somewhere that doesn't get as cold as Massachusetts. I think that it just gets too cold to use them for a large portion of the school year."

One of AHS' environmental science teachers, Melanie Cutler shares her vision for a greener AHS. She emphasizes energy efficiency and reduced greenhouse gas emissions, stating, "In an ideal world, a new or renovated school would use significantly less energy." Cutler addressed the overcrowding issue, a massive problem at the high school according to the community. She expresses openness to portable classrooms not only because of how it would create more space to relieve the overcrowding, but also due to their comfort and potential benefits for student exercise. She encourages some sort of update, whether that be renovation or portables due to the existing HVAC system at AHS. Cutler acknowledges its safety but advocates for modernization to enhance energy efficiency and climate control. She also cites Lexington High as a successful reproduction of these portable classrooms as an example to higher ups and the community.

But in conversation with Darlington, he continues to come back to a shiny new, environmentally sustainable school of the community's dream, minus the price tag. Darlington beamed when speaking about tackling the present issues of a leaky building in a new school, aiming for better (if not airtight) insulation and promising a more comfortable environment while minimizing air pollutants and pollen.

Senior Opinions & Plans on Upcoming Presidential Election

Ella Hu || STAFF WRITER

As many seniors like Annabel Pierce apply and will receive their college decision letters this year, it is also the year of the 2024 presidential election. Switching on the TV and watching candidates debate has always been the usual. However, as primary and caucus debates are soon underway, realizing they can now vote and participate in the election is shocking and foreign. Many similar to Pierce have mixed feelings, both apprehensive and optimistic about the election and participating in it.

Some feel excited to participate in their first national election, while others are concerned and apprehensive as caucuses and eventual election day draw near. Politicians with strongly contrasting views and ideas bring seniors to focus on the election process more than ever before.

Senior William Tutwiler expressed his concern regarding the 2024 election. "Some of the ideas I hear floating around from politicians are very dangerous and can have a large impact," he said.

Seniors at AHS this year will be old enough to participate in the upcoming presidential election. Despite being excited to partake in their first voting experience, most are tense and concerned about the results and the impacts they will have.

The election would be a substantial event for Senior Michaela Buckley, a human rights advocate. "The biggest parts are human rights and the policies surrounding that," she said. "This presidential election will be very important for human rights issues."

Want to read the rest of the story?
Check out our website at
andoverview.net!

COURTESY PHOTO / **Edward Mukalazi**
Seniors Will Tutwiler, Michaela Buckley, and Edward Mukalazi, interview U.S. representative Seth Moulton.